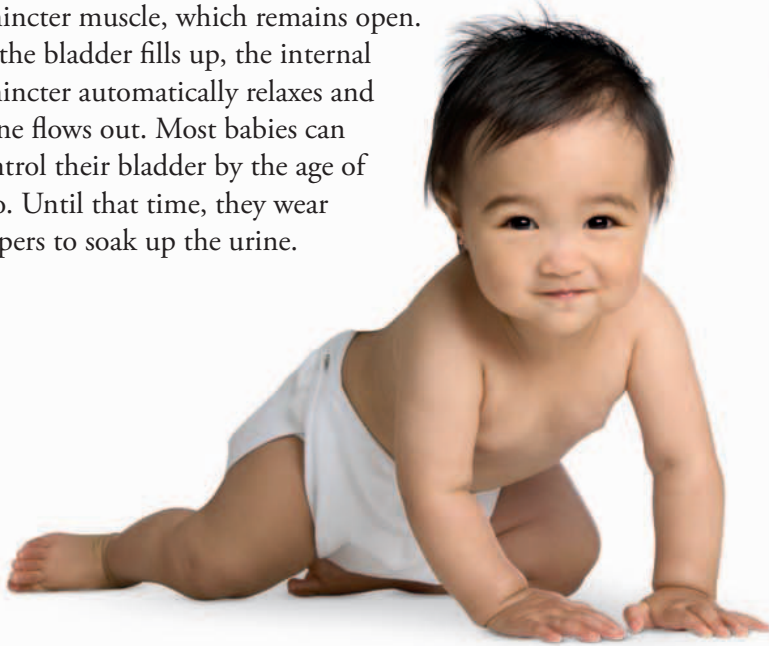


NO CONTROL

Babies can't control the bladder's external sphincter muscle, which remains open. As the bladder fills up, the internal sphincter automatically relaxes and urine flows out. Most babies can control their bladder by the age of two. Until that time, they wear diapers to soak up the urine.



WOW!

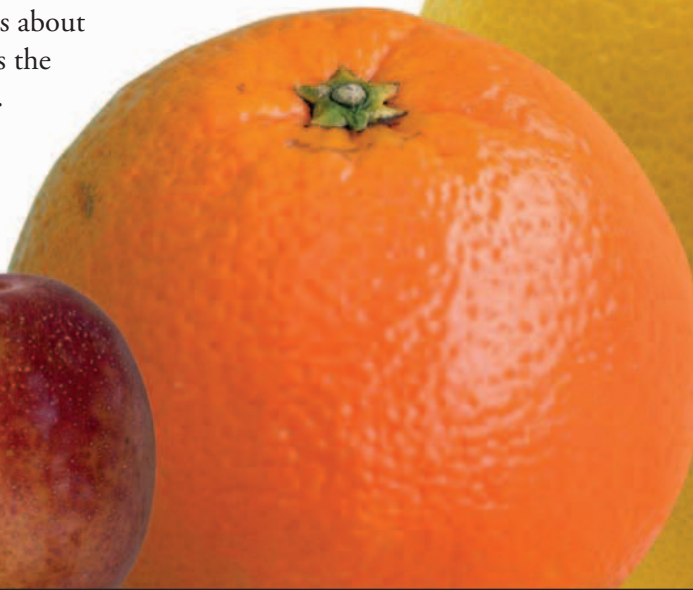
Globally, humans release 1.7 trillion gallons (6.4 trillion liters) of urine each year, enough to fill a lake.

FULL STRETCH

The wall of the bladder is extremely stretchy. This means that it can expand as it fills with urine. When it is empty, the bladder is about the size of a plum. As it fills, it reaches the size of an orange, or even a grapefruit. By this stage, you will really feel the need to go to the bathroom!



Plum



Orange



Grapefruit

HOW MUCH?

The amount of urine made each day, and how concentrated it is, depends on how much you drink and whether or not your body is sweating. The hypothalamus in your brain has overall control, monitoring water levels in your blood. If there's too little, it tells the pituitary gland to release a hormone into the blood. This hormone tells the kidneys to absorb more water into the bloodstream and make smaller amounts of stronger urine.

The hypothalamus monitors the concentration of water in the blood.

The pituitary gland releases hormones into the blood.

